

Overall, the most striking trend is that while China's population is expected to plateau and then gradually decline, India's population is projected to grow steadily, leading to India overtaking China as the world's most populous country around the year 2030.

In the year 2000, China's population stood at approximately 1.26 billion, which was significantly higher than India's population of about 1.0 billion. During the first decade (2000–2010), both countries experienced growth, with China remaining the clear leader.

However, the trajectories begin to diverge after 2010. China's growth slows down considerably, and its population curve starts to flatten, peaking at around 1.45 billion between 2030 and 2040. After 2040, China's population enters a period of decline, falling to just under 1.4 billion by 2050.

In contrast, India's population shows a continuous and steady increase throughout the entire period. It rises from 1.0 billion in 2000 to approximately **1.27 billion in 2015**, and then to about **1.4 billion in 2025**. The crossover happens **around the year 2030**, where India's population surpasses China's. By 2050, India's population is projected to reach approximately 1.6 billion, while China's population falls to around 1.38 billion.